



a creative journey

FRANCIS GALAN

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A-LEVELS

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Product Design - Desk Design

PERSONAL WORKS

Sewing - ONE : HUNDRED

Barbering - Galanacci Cuts

THE CRAFT OF BOXING

sculpting
the body and mind

My thesis focused on resolving the problem of mental health through the use of sport as a form of therapy and I have chosen boxing due to Merthyr Tydfil's history for producing some of boxing greats in the late 1800s and early 1900s. Currently, Merthyr is living off from its past and it is time to learn from what was there before and put the community's wellbeing in the forefront unlike the time of the industrial revolution where the people of Merthyr were put into harsh working conditions where they were neglected as humans and seen as pure workforce. Cyfarthfa Ironworks is a unique location and has all the building blocks to house a successful social intervention.

The project aims to create a place where people can improve themselves physically and mentally, a place that produces healthy bodied and minded people, and perhaps produce future champions that will bring pride back to Merthyr Tydfil but also the project aims to raise awareness for mental health as many people are afraid to seek help due to the stigma of mental health not having any physically recognisable traits so that some may not consider it as an important issue to tackle. My proposal will be diverse and include the whole community as mental health problems can affect anyone of any age therefore the real challenge is implementing the aspects of boxing that would allow a wide variety of ages to come together and fight this issue as a community a step at a time.



THE CRAFT OF LOOKING

Visting Merthyr Tydfil to gain an understanding of the place which led to developing a design proposal.



Ironworks ruin from the outside.



Ironworks ruin from the inside.

CRAFTING OUT A BRIEF

I created a brief that considered my findings, exploration of themes, issues and opportunities for my project in Merthyr Tydfil.



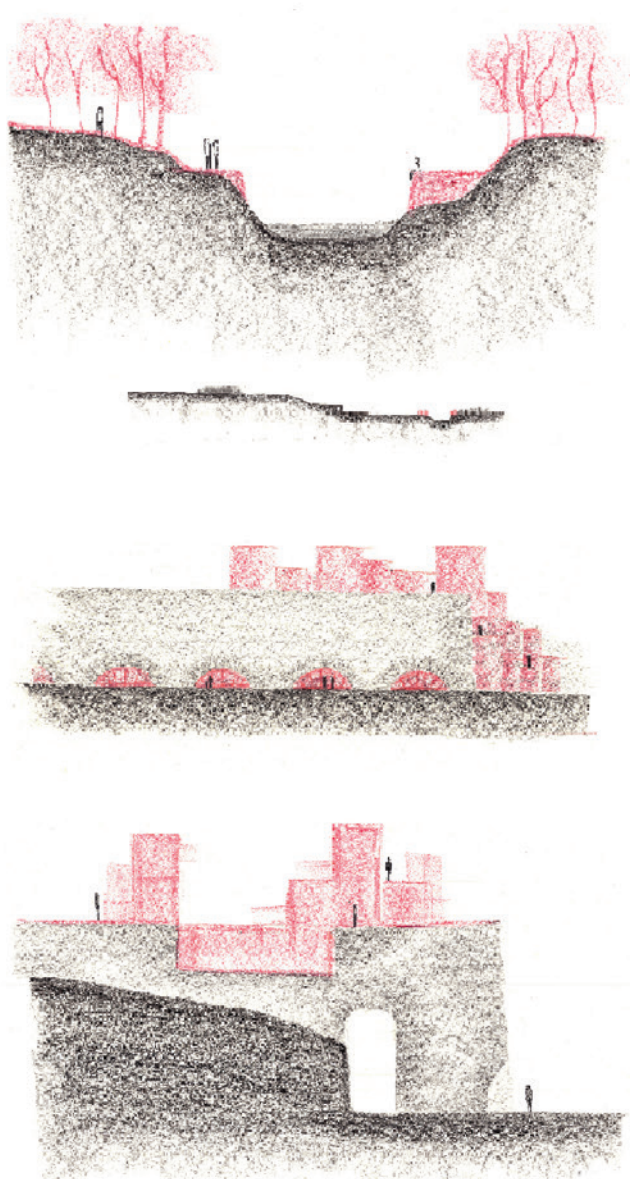
Ironworks History Collage

MATERIAL CONCIOUSNESS

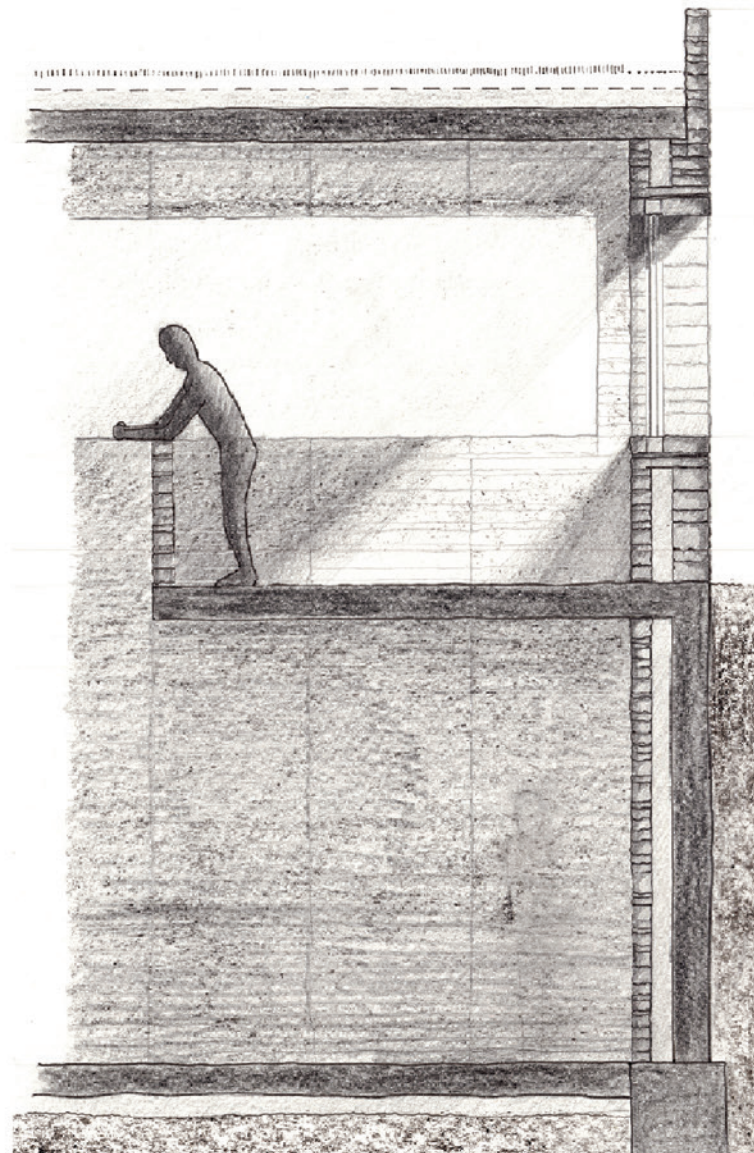
Pushing ideas gathered from my brief into spatial and architectural ambition.



An Idea of a Moment - Threshold Model



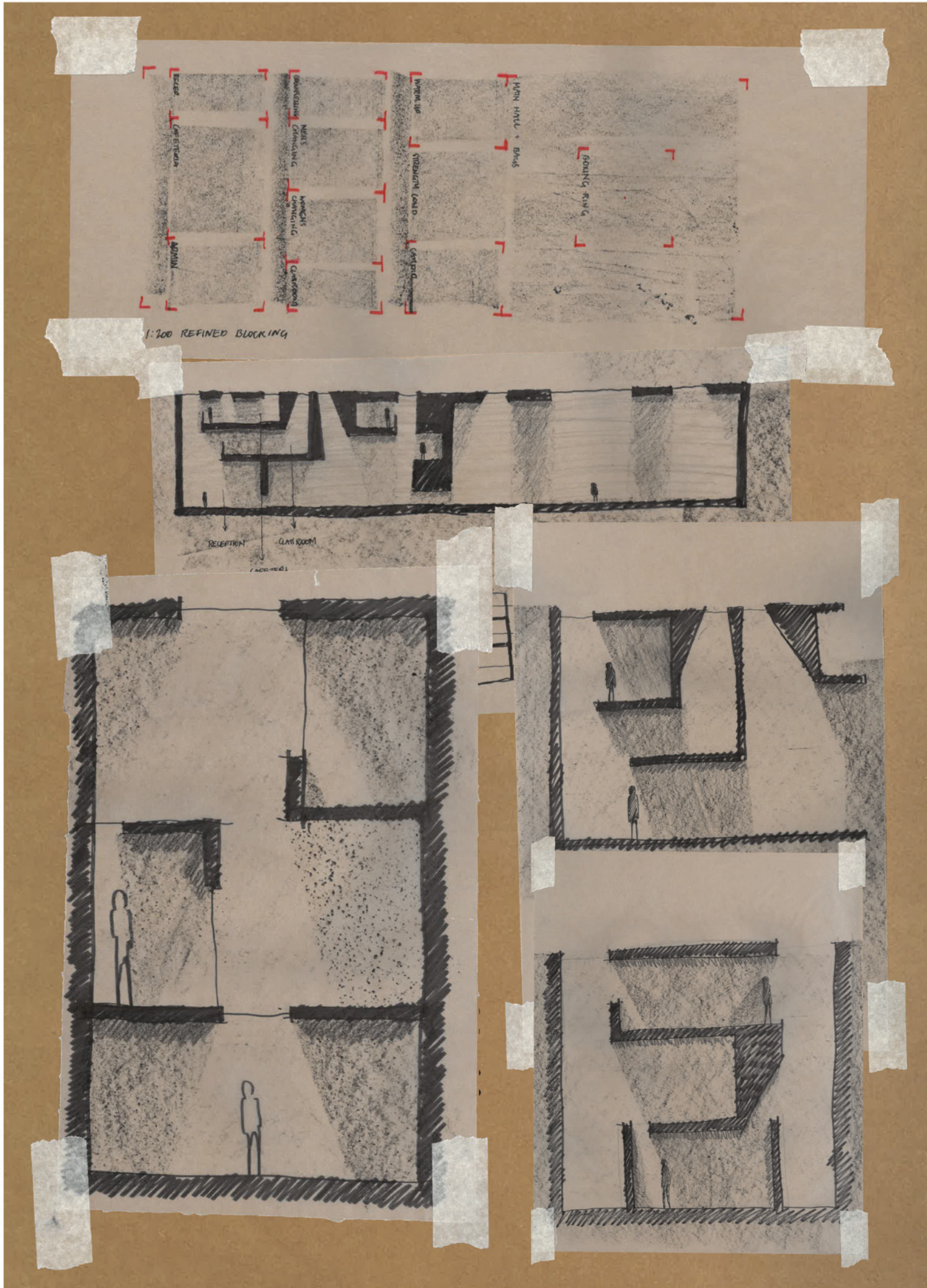
Macro/Micro Informs - Sketching Ideas



Developed Detail - Section Drawing of the Threshold

ARCHITECTURAL DEVELOPMENT

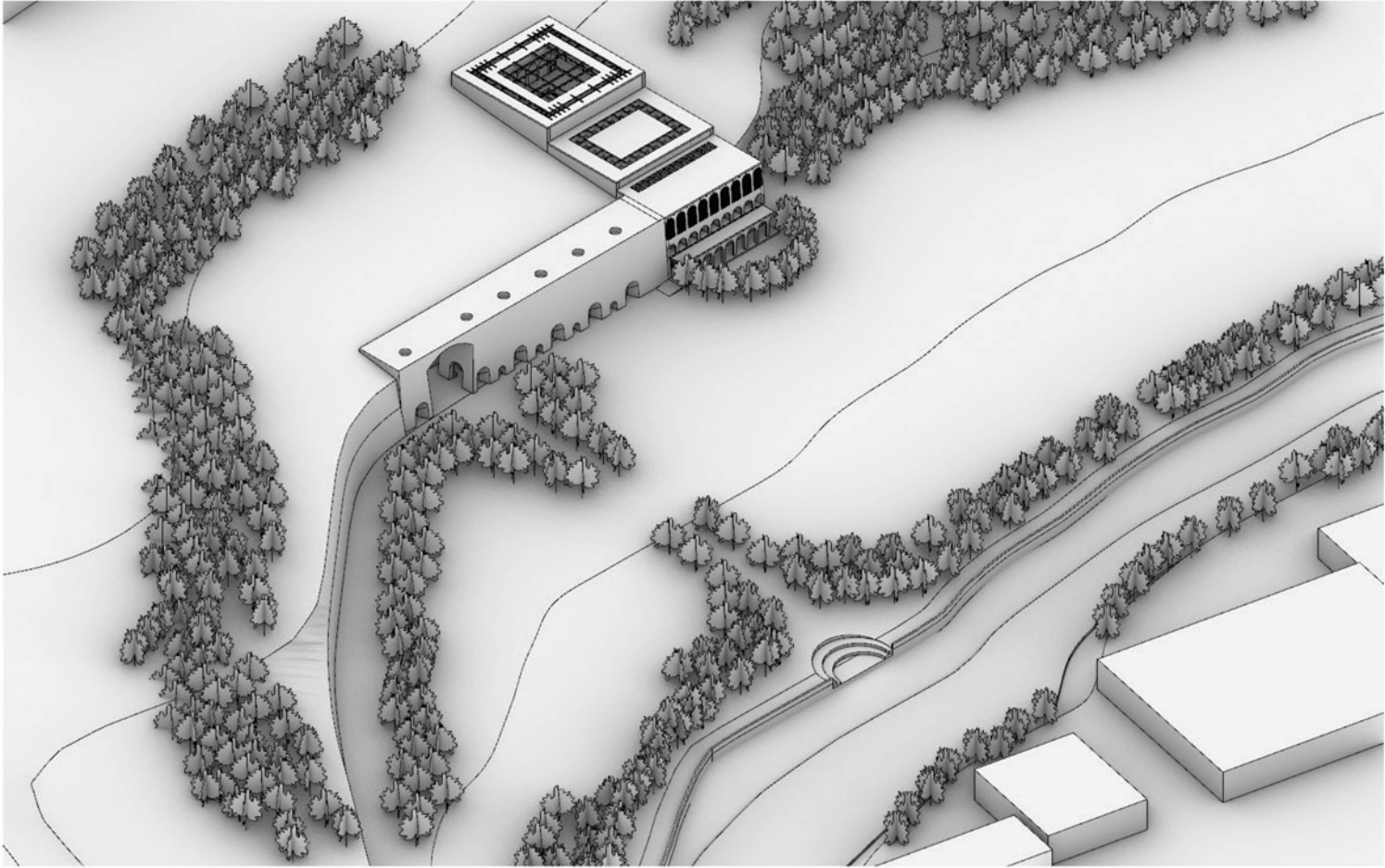
Further developing my design ideas manifested from my brief.



Design Ideas - sketches of spatial qualities on tracing paper

IDEAS VISUALIZED

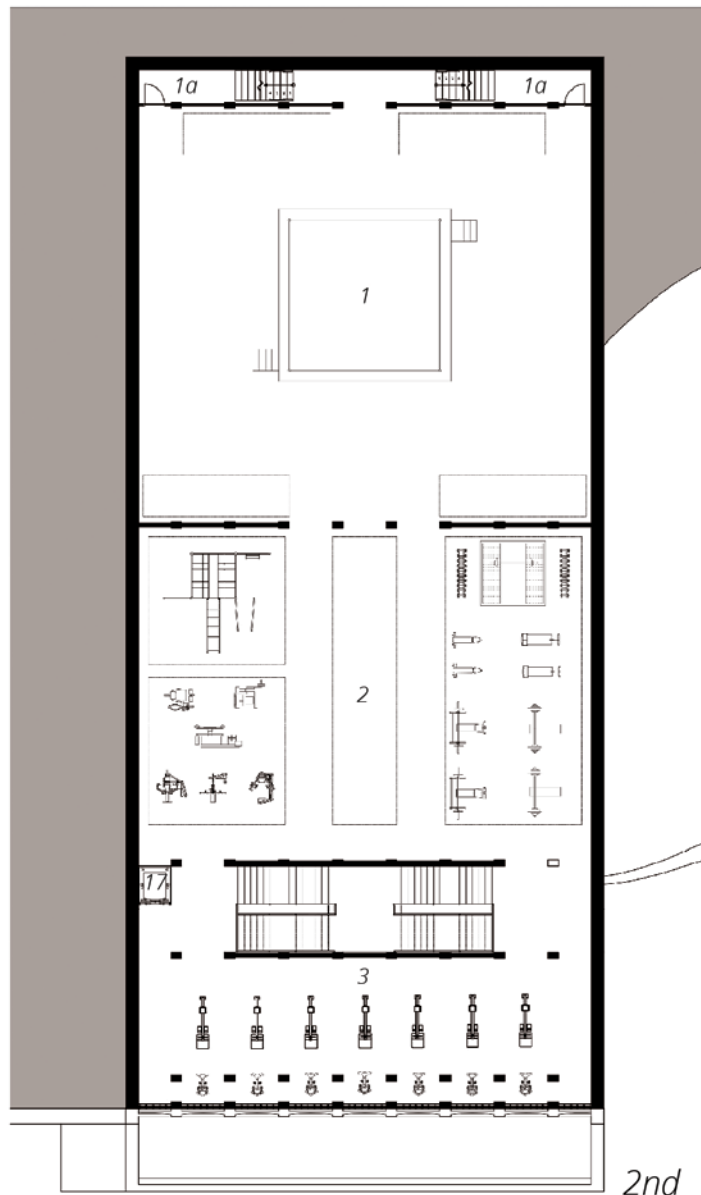
Turning my sketches into CAD drawings, 3D models and visualisations.



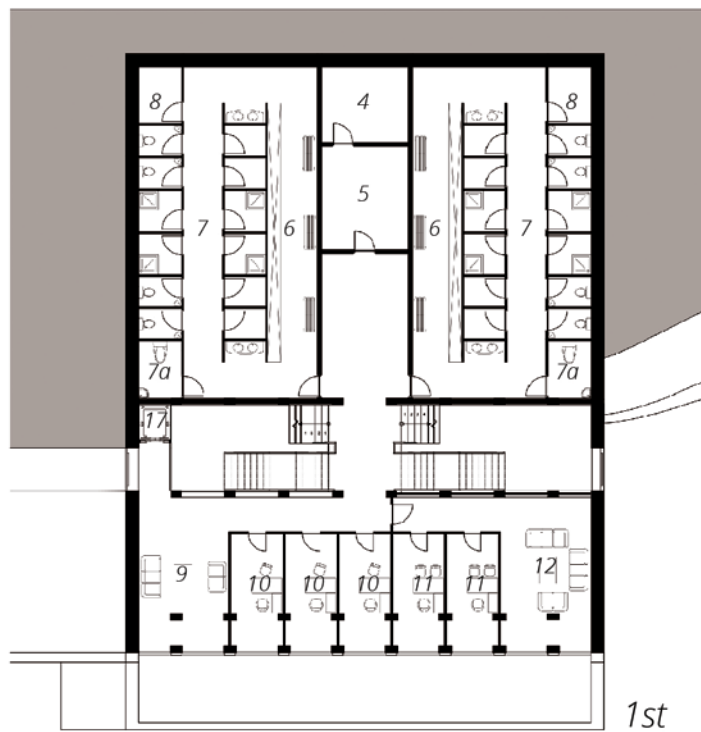
Axonometric Site Model



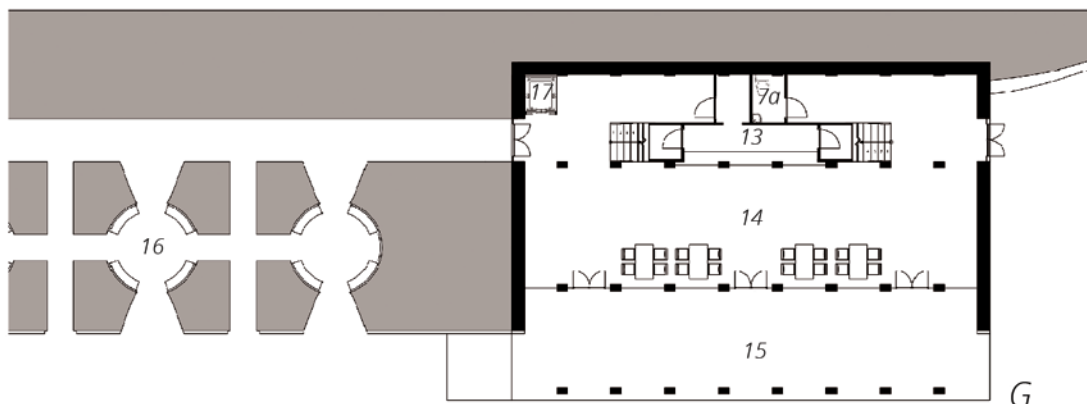
Masterplan Layout



- 1 Boxing Zone
- 1a Storage Room
- 2 Strength and Conditioning Zone
- 3 Cardio Zone
- 4 Plant Room
- 5 Utility Room
- 6 Men and Women Locker Room
- 7 Shower Area /Private Changing Room
- 7a Disabled Toilet
- 8 Janitor Room
- 9 Waiting Room
- 10 Counselling Rooms
- 11 Offices
- 12 Staff Room
- 13 Mini Cafe
- 14 Reception
- 15 Terrace
- 16 Ironworks and Blastfurnace Social Area
- 17 Lift



1st



G



*A blissful path that runs along the side of
the river,
the wind blows and the trees whisper.*

*Negative thoughts running through your
mind,
stay focused and leave the negative
thoughts behind.*

*It's only the beginning,
but it's important you keep moving.*

*You move closer towards your destination;
you feel a sense of determination.*



*The calm before the storm has passed,
you're at your destination at last.*

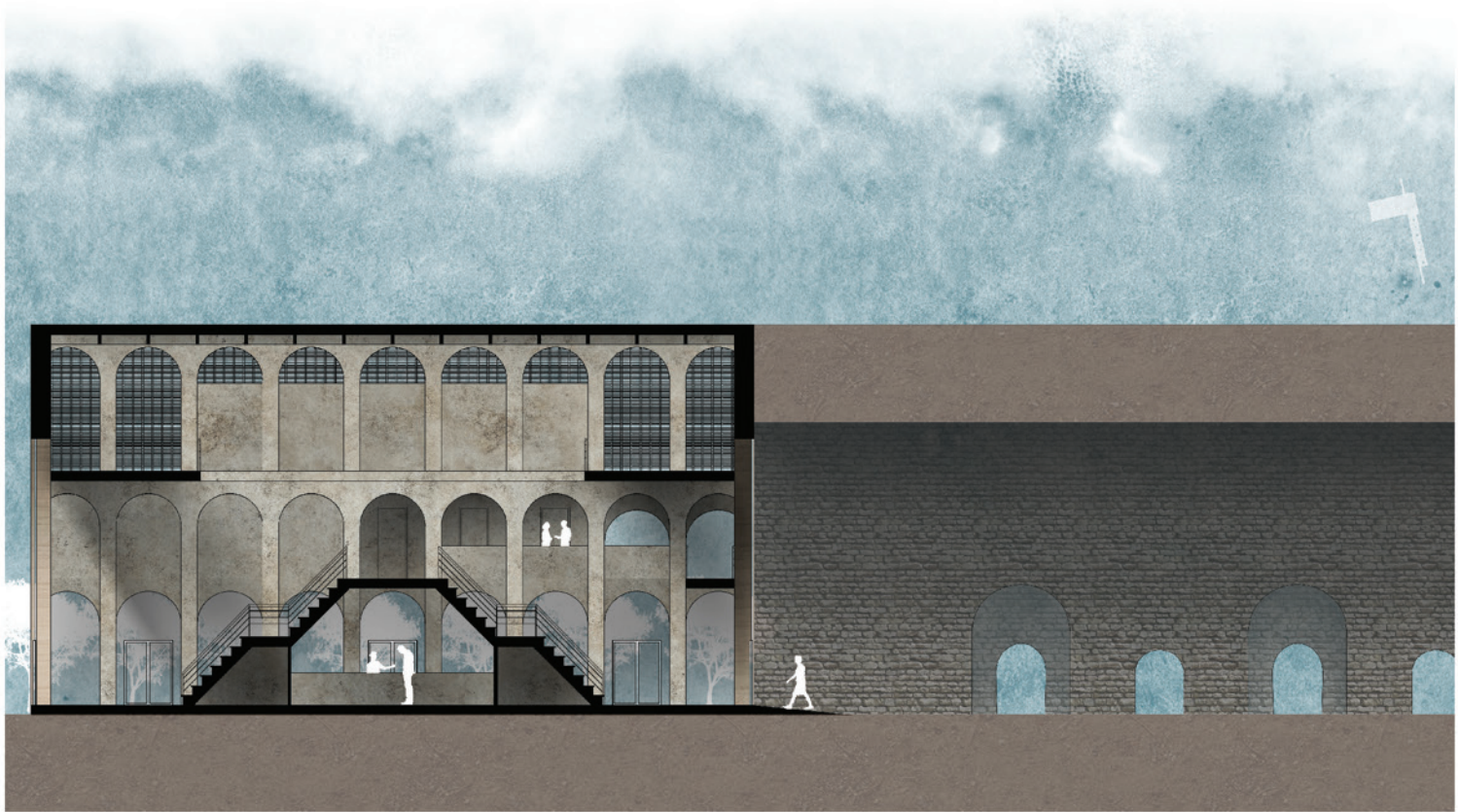
*The ironworks surrounded by the greenery,
it's a beautiful scenery.*

*All that separates you is the threshold;
a dry-stone structure that feels cold.*

*You inch closer to the entrance
with a sense of presence.*



The Journey and the Destination - Poetic Narrative



*Through the hallway with dimly lit walls,
an echo that calls;*

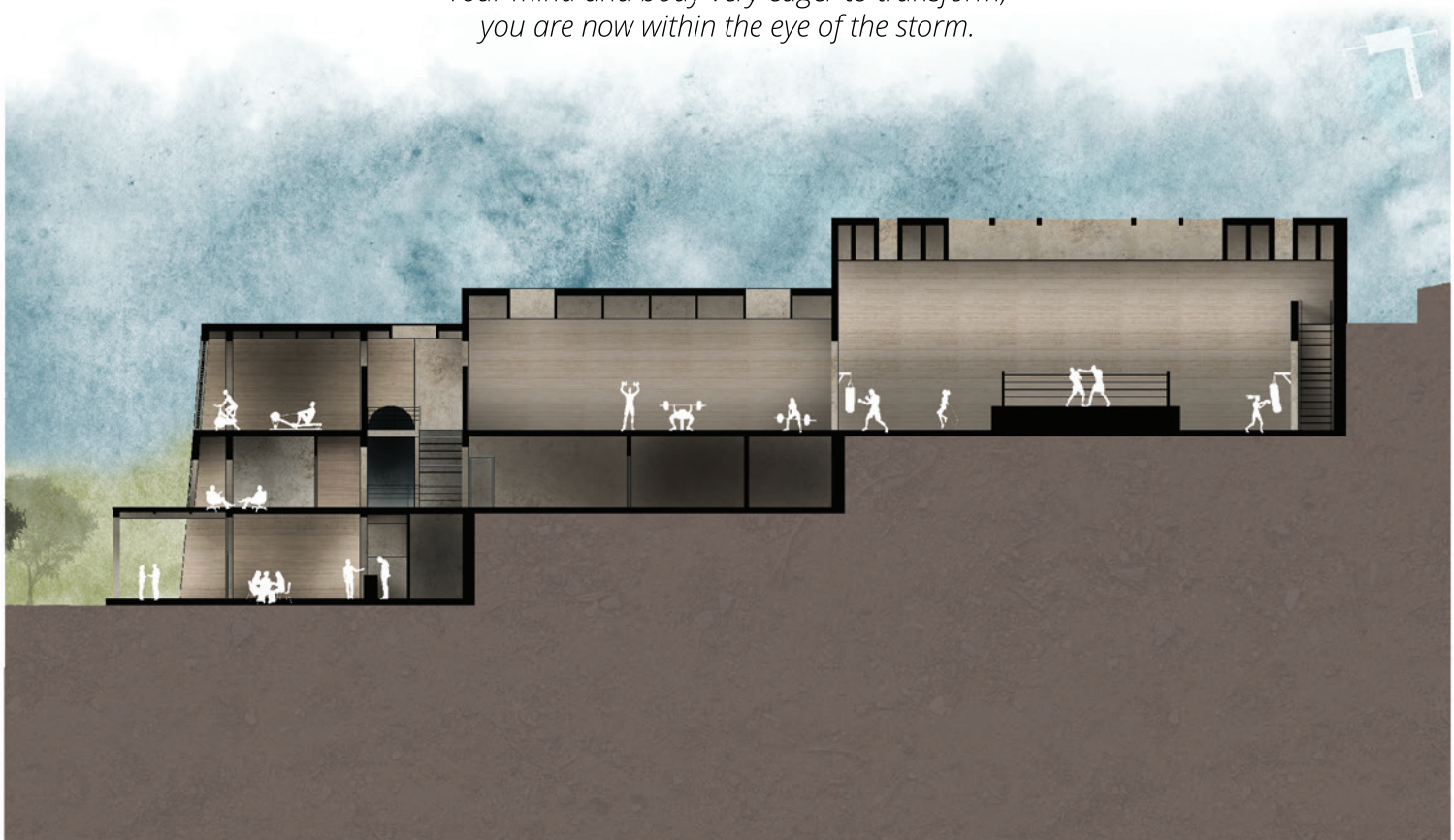
*the sound of movement,
each step you take is a step closer to improvement.*

*You suddenly emerge from the shadows;
greeted by tall walls and punched out windows;*

*sunlight scatter through with a framed view,
it's within these walls you let your energy spew.*

*Time to focus on improving,
and keep your body moving.*

*Your mind and body very eager to transform,
you are now within the eye of the storm.*



Section A & B



Public Entrance



Cardio Space



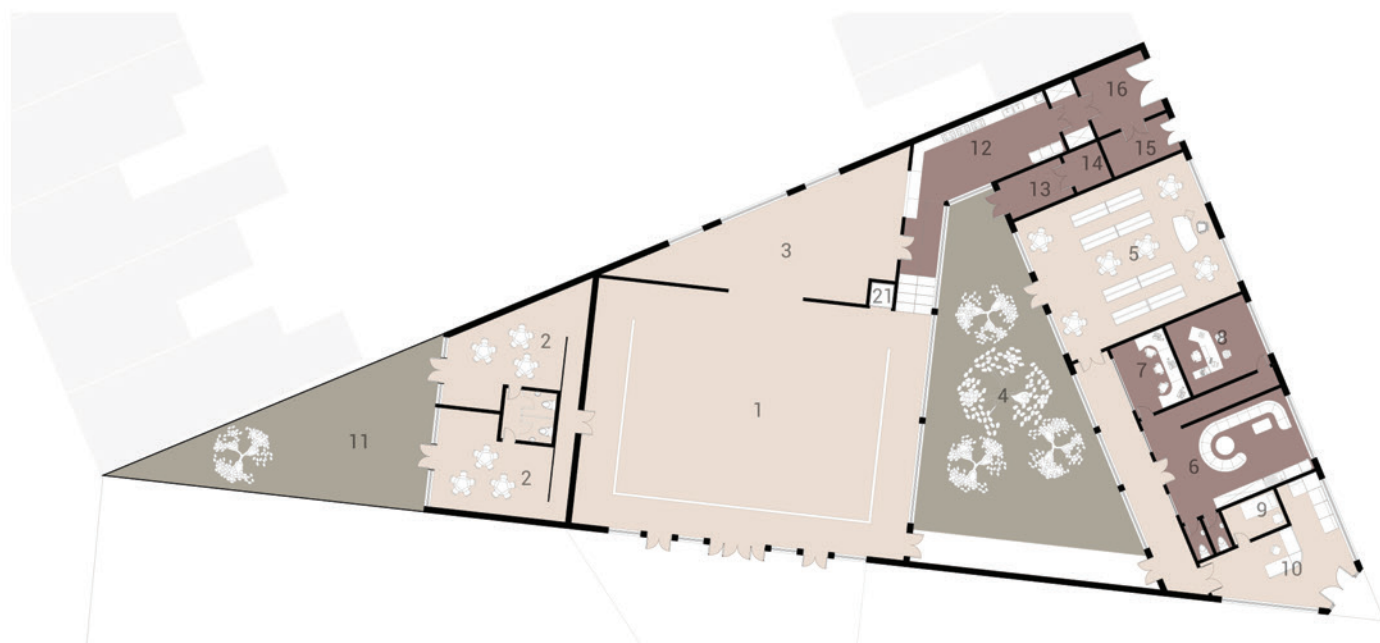
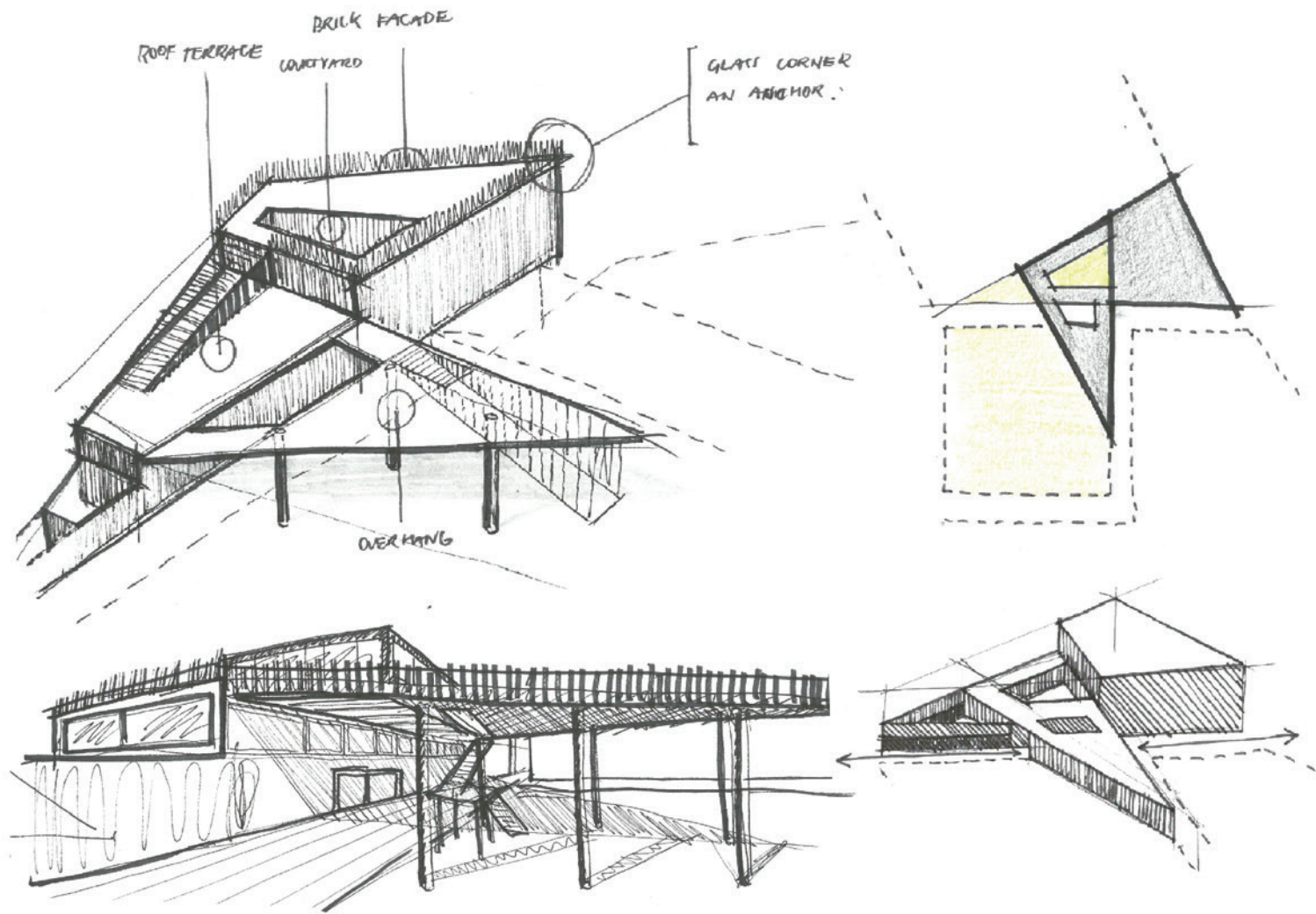
Transition Staircase



Main Boxing Hall

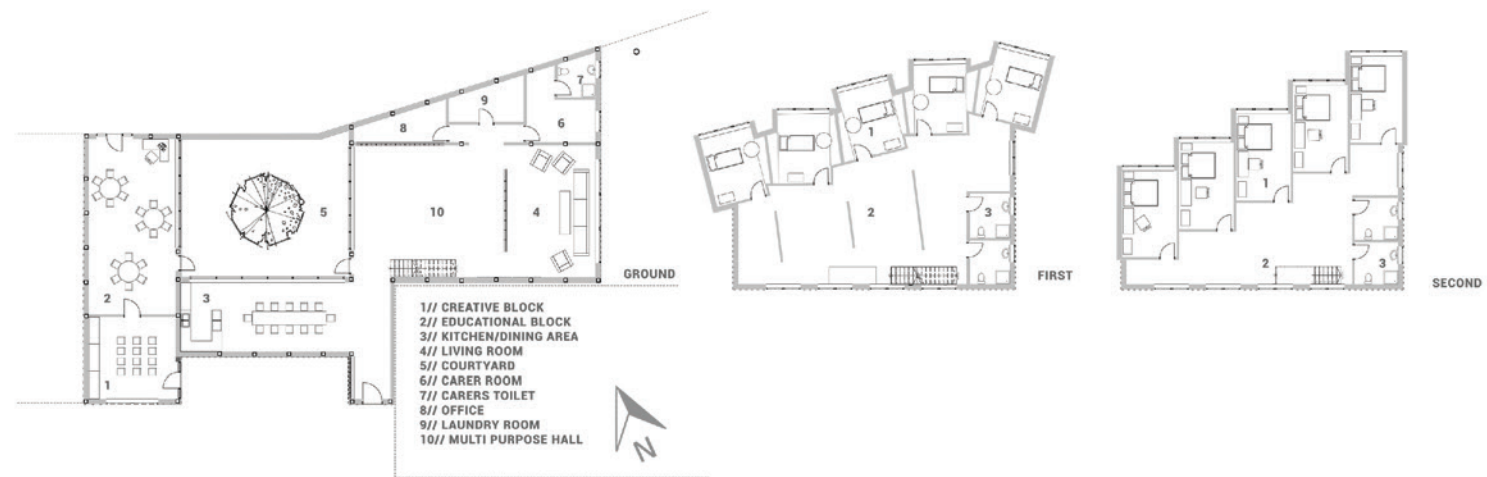
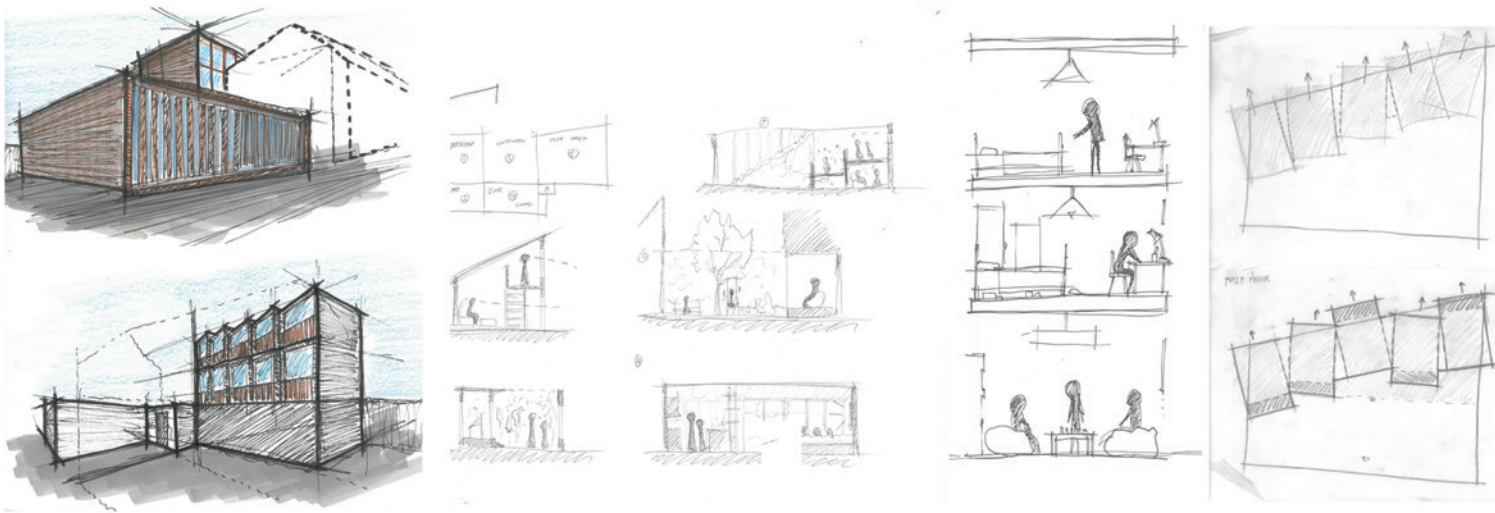
GREEN HIGH PRIMARY SCHOOL

Building vertically to occupy less space, creating more open greenery for the community to share and allowing a closer relationship with nature.



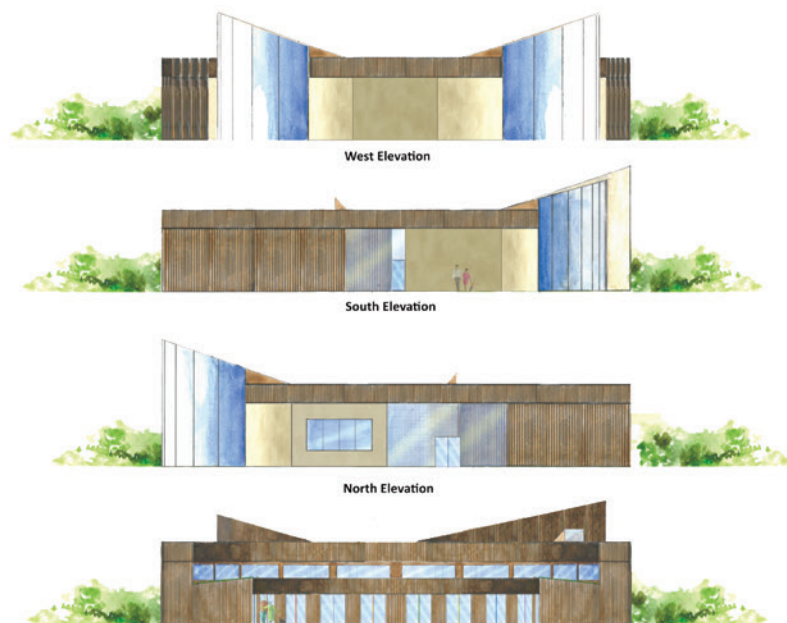
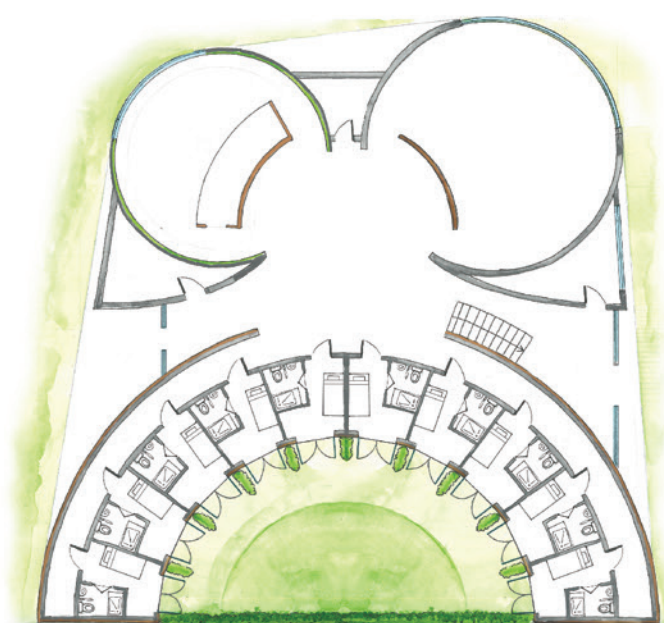
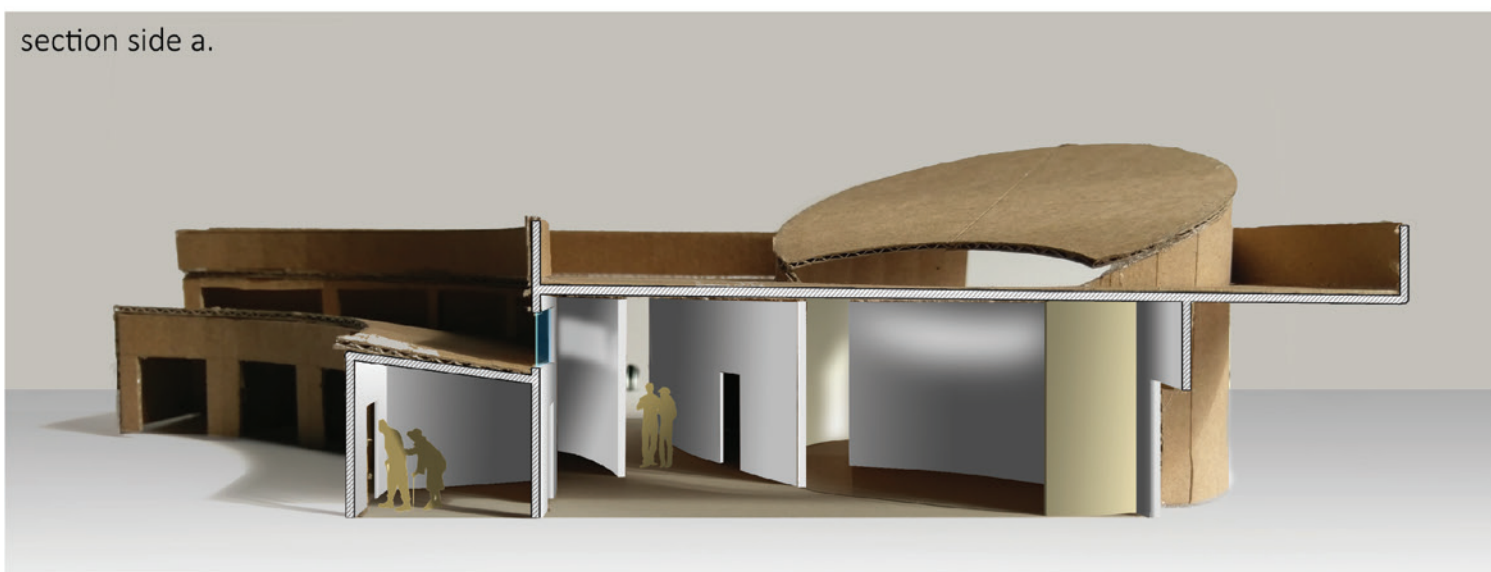
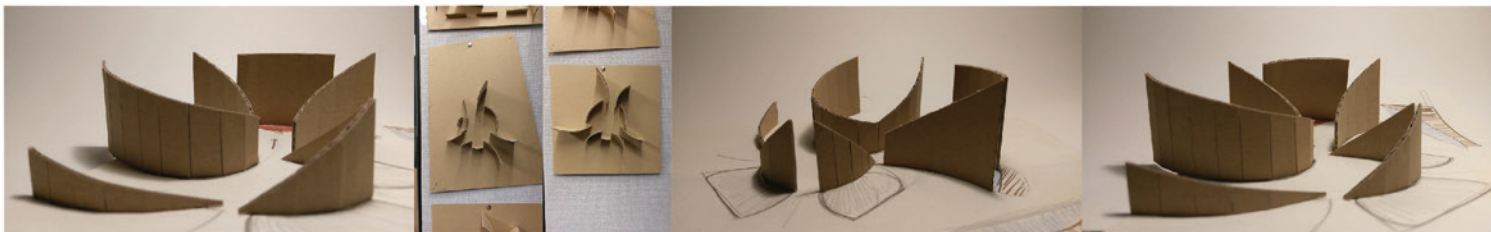
CHILD REFUGEE HOME

Provide temporary home for unaccompanied minors who are seeking asylum in the UK until they are reunited with their families or partnered with foster parents.



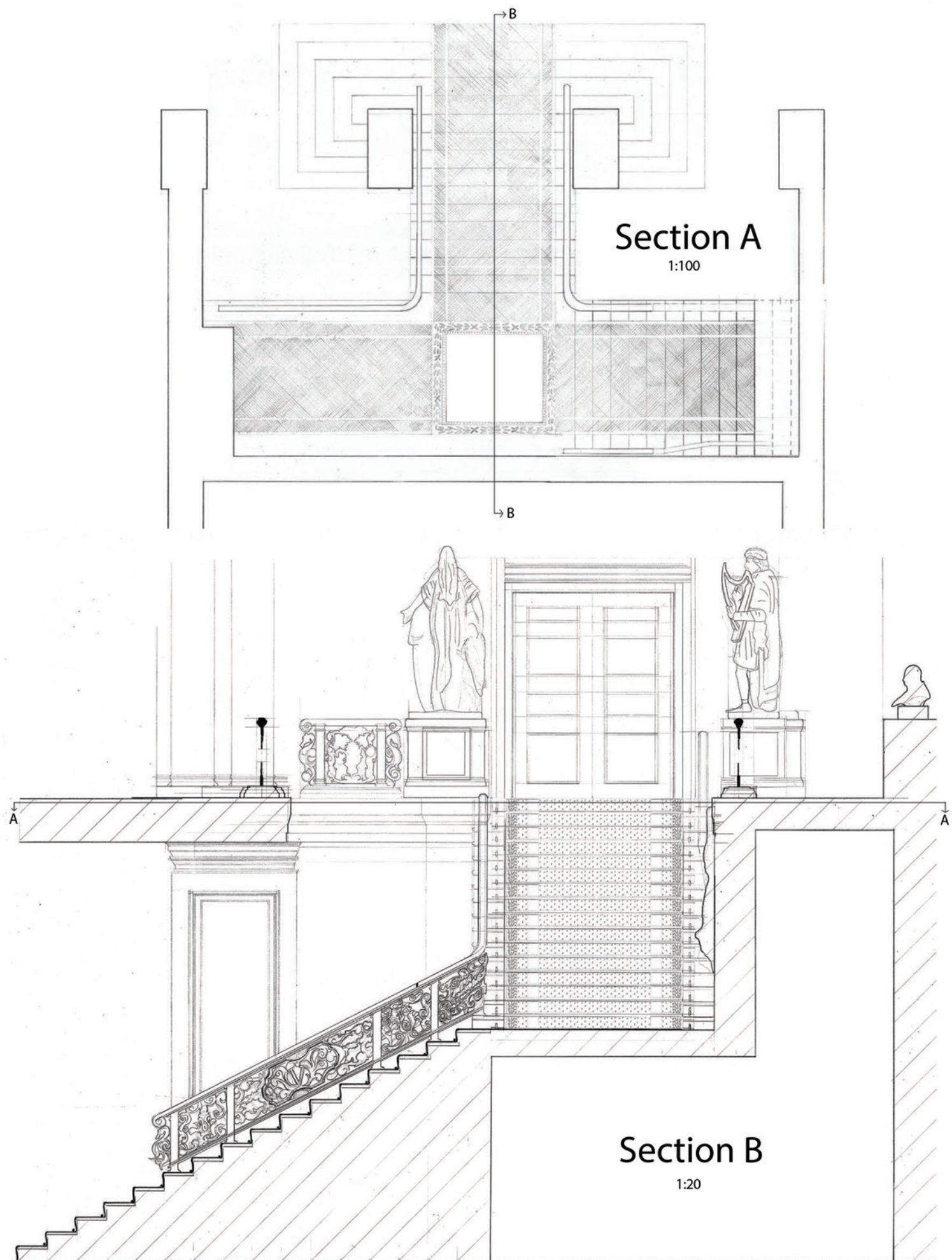
DEMENTIA CARE HOME

Using architectural design to aid people's wayfindingabilities within a care home especially those with dementia.



TECHNICAL DRAWING

Analysed the City Hall staircase in Cardiff for one of my modules and I had to create a 1:20 section drawing of the staircase. This is when I learnt how to draw technical drawings for architecture.



PREVIOUS WORKS

A-LEVELS

Fine Arts - Chiaroscuro

Product Design - Desk Design

PERSONAL WORKS

Sewing - ONE : HUNDRED

Barbering - Galanacci Cuts

CHIAROSCURO

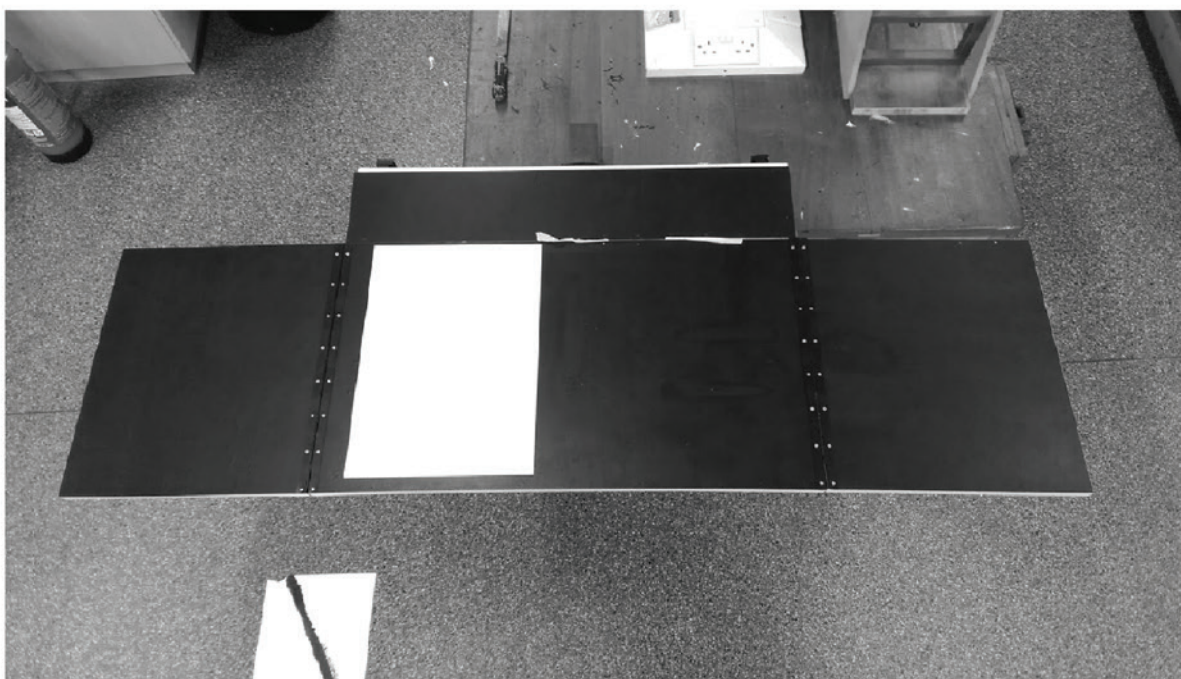
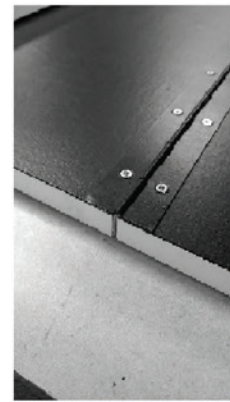
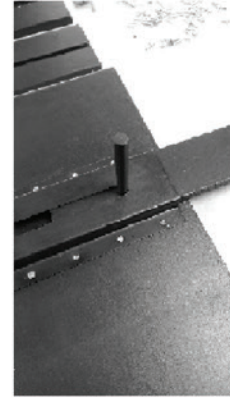
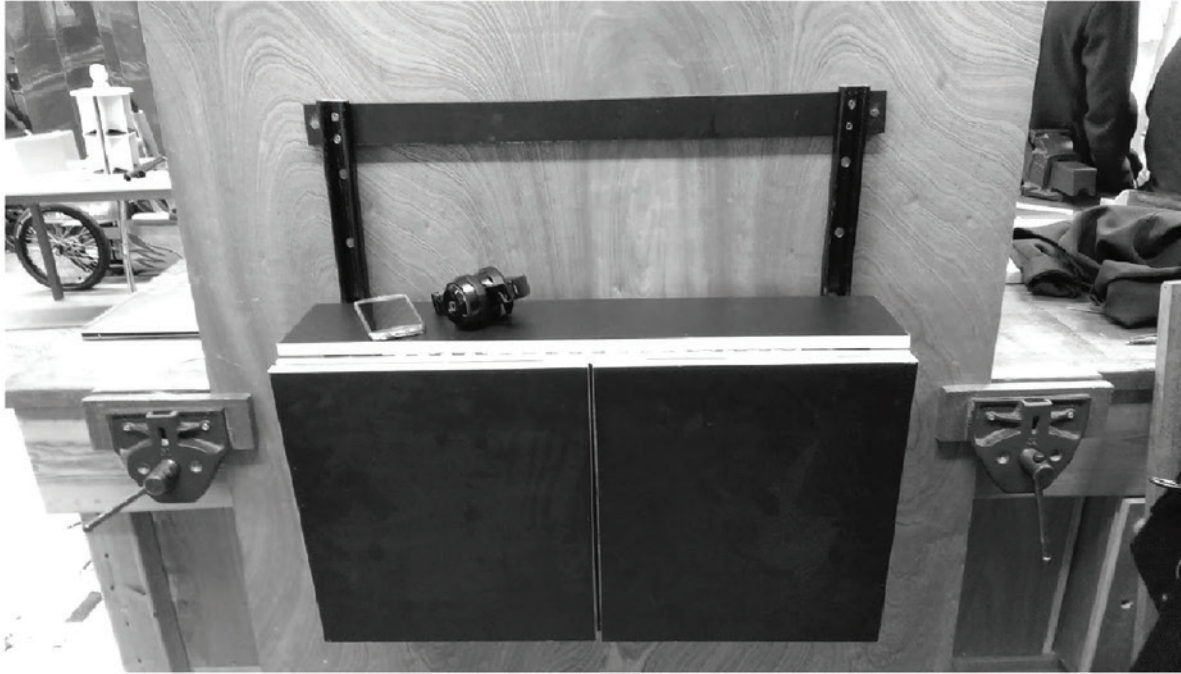
My new found love for portraiture drove me into creating a portrait series inspired by Caravaggio. I was intrigued by how he used dramatic lighting within his works.



a-levels | 2016 | fine arts project

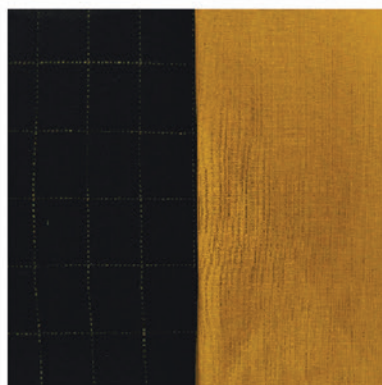
DESK DESIGN

My interest in design began from studying product design in A-Levels. In my last year I pushed myself to design and make a 3-in-1 desk aimed at students in university accommodation with limited space.



SEWING

During university I had friends who were also into fashion and we started a project that combined architecture and fashion; we made a jumper from scratch which I sewed together.



personal works | 2018 | one : hundred

BARBERING

I was always interested in the craft of barbering. It amazed me how a quality haircut can give someone confidence. So, I gave it a go, got really good and ended up doing it as a side hustle whilst studying architecture.



personal works | 2019 | galanacci cuts